

Plan Benefits & Coverage Guide

Individual | Family | Employer-Sponsored | Supplemental
Plan Year 2026

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About MeridianHealth Plans

MeridianHealth Insurance offers ACA-compliant health plans across four metal tiers — Bronze, Silver, Gold, and Platinum — as well as employer-sponsored group plans and supplemental health coverage. All ACA-compliant plans cover the ten Essential Health Benefits (EHBs) mandated under Section 1302(b) of the Affordable Care Act. Supplemental plans are non-ACA products and are subject to separate benefit schedules, waiting periods, and exclusion terms as described in the Terms and Conditions (Document MH-TC-2026-047). This brochure summarizes plan benefits; for the complete list of exclusions, refer to the Claim Exclusion Reference (Document MH-EXC-2026-047).

Plan Categories

MeridianHealth markets five plan families. Individual and Family plans are sold directly on the ACA Marketplace and off-exchange. Employer-Sponsored plans are offered through small and large group arrangements. The MeridianHealth Supplemental Shield plan provides additional coverage for critical illness, accident, and hospital indemnity and is available as a rider to any base plan or as a standalone policy. The Supplemental Shield plan is not an ACA-qualified health plan and does not satisfy the individual mandate where applicable.

Cost-Sharing Summary by Metal Tier

The following table compares annual deductibles, copayment amounts, coinsurance rates, and out-of-pocket maximums for MeridianHealth's four ACA-compliant metal tiers for Plan Year 2026. All figures shown are for in-network services. Out-of-network cost-sharing is detailed in Section 4. Employer-Sponsored plans follow the Gold tier schedule unless the employer selects a different tier at enrollment.

Benefit	Bronze 60	Silver 70	Gold 80	Platinum 90
Annual Deductible (Individual)	\$7,500	\$4,500	\$1,750	\$500
Annual Deductible (Family)	\$15,000	\$9,000	\$3,500	\$1,000
Out-of-Pocket Max (Individual)	\$9,450	\$8,200	\$6,800	\$3,500
Out-of-Pocket Max (Family)	\$18,900	\$16,400	\$13,600	\$7,000
Primary Care Visit Copay	\$45	\$35	\$25	\$15
Specialist Visit Copay	\$80	\$65	\$50	\$30
Urgent Care Copay	\$75	\$60	\$45	\$25
Emergency Room Copay	\$450	\$350	\$250	\$150
Coinsurance (after deductible)	40%	30%	20%	10%
Inpatient Hospital (per day)	\$750/day	\$500/day	\$350/day	\$200/day

Note: All ACA-compliant plans observe the federal out-of-pocket maximum ceiling of \$10,600 (individual) / \$21,200 (family) for Plan Year 2026, per CMS guidance. The Supplemental Shield plan does not have an out-of-pocket maximum.

Essential Health Benefits Coverage

All MeridianHealth ACA-compliant plans cover the following ten Essential Health Benefits categories without annual or lifetime dollar limits on covered services:

Ambulatory Patient Services. Office visits, outpatient surgery, and same-day procedures at in-network facilities are covered subject to the copay and coinsurance schedule. Prior authorization is required for outpatient surgical procedures exceeding \$2,500 in estimated charges.

Emergency Services. Emergency room visits at any licensed facility — in-network or out-of-network — are covered at the in-network cost-sharing rate. If the patient is admitted directly from the ER, the ER copay is waived and inpatient hospital benefits apply.

Hospitalization. Inpatient hospital stays are covered subject to the per-day copay for the first five days, followed by coinsurance for each additional day. Semi-private room accommodation is the standard benefit. Private room upgrade is covered only when medically necessary.

Maternity and Newborn Care. Prenatal visits, delivery (vaginal and cesarean), and postnatal care for mother and newborn are covered. Newborn coverage extends for the first 30 days under the mother's policy. The newborn must be enrolled as a dependent within 31 days of birth to continue coverage.

Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Services. Outpatient therapy sessions are covered at the specialist copay rate. Inpatient behavioral health and substance use disorder treatment is covered at the same coinsurance rate as medical/surgical inpatient stays, consistent with the Mental Health Parity and Addiction Equity Act. Prior authorization is required for residential treatment programs exceeding 14 consecutive days.

Prescription Drugs. MeridianHealth uses a four-tier formulary: Tier 1 (generic) — \$10 copay; Tier 2 (preferred brand) — \$35 copay; Tier 3 (non-preferred brand) — \$70 copay; Tier 4 (specialty) — 30% coinsurance up to \$300 per fill. Preventive medications on the ACA preventive drug list are covered at \$0 cost-sharing.

Rehabilitative and Habilitative Services. Physical therapy, occupational therapy, and speech-language pathology are covered up to 30 combined visits per plan year at the specialist copay. Additional visits require prior authorization. Habilitative services for developmental conditions in dependents under age 19 are not subject to visit limits.

Laboratory Services. Diagnostic lab work ordered by an in-network provider is covered at 100% after the applicable copay when performed at an in-network lab. Out-of-network lab services are subject to the out-of-network coinsurance rate.

Preventive and Wellness Services. Preventive care services recommended by the U.S. Preventive Services Task Force (USPSTF) with a rating of A or B are covered at 100% with no cost-sharing when received from an in-network provider. This includes annual wellness exams, immunizations, and cancer screenings.

Pediatric Services. Pediatric dental and vision services are included as an Essential Health Benefit for dependents under age 19. Dental benefits include two preventive visits per year and basic restorative services. Vision benefits include one annual eye exam and one pair of corrective lenses per plan year.

In-Network and Out-of-Network Benefits

MeridianHealth maintains a preferred provider organization (PPO) network across all 22 licensed states. Members may receive care from any licensed provider, but out-of-network services are subject to higher cost-sharing and balance billing. Out-of-network coinsurance is 50% after the out-of-network deductible, which is twice the in-network deductible for the member's plan tier. Out-of-network charges exceeding the Maximum Allowable Amount (MAA) are the member's responsibility and do not count toward the out-of-pocket maximum.

Emergency services are always covered at the in-network cost-sharing rate regardless of provider network status, per the No Surprises Act. Air ambulance services from out-of-network providers are also covered at the in-network rate.

Prescription Drug Benefits — Detailed

Tier	Category	Retail (30-day)	Mail Order (90-day)
Tier 1	Generic	\$10 copay	\$25 copay
Tier 2	Preferred Brand	\$35 copay	\$87.50 copay
Tier 3	Non-Preferred Brand	\$70 copay	\$175 copay
Tier 4	Specialty	30% coins. (max \$300)	Not available by mail

Specialty medications on Tier 4 require prior authorization and must be dispensed through MeridianHealth's specialty pharmacy partner. Step therapy protocols require members to try a Tier 1 or Tier 2 alternative before a Tier 3 or Tier 4 medication will be approved, unless the prescribing physician provides clinical justification. The step therapy requirement does not apply to medications used for cancer treatment, organ transplant anti-rejection, or HIV/AIDS antiretroviral therapy.

Supplemental Shield Plan Benefits

The MeridianHealth Supplemental Shield plan is a non-ACA indemnity product that pays fixed cash benefits directly to the policyholder. Benefits are paid regardless of other insurance. The Supplemental Shield plan has a 90-day waiting period for illness-related claims; accident-related claims have no waiting period. Pre-existing conditions are subject to a 12-month waiting period from the policy effective date (see Terms and Conditions, Section 5.3). Available in all 22 licensed states except New York.

Benefit	Amount
Critical Illness Lump Sum (first diagnosis)	\$10,000 / \$25,000 / \$50,000 (selected at enrollment)
Hospital Confinement Indemnity	\$250 per day (max 30 days per confinement)
ICU Confinement Indemnity	\$500 per day (max 15 days per confinement)
Accident Emergency Room Visit	\$200 per visit (max 3 visits per year)
Accident Follow-Up Treatment	\$75 per visit (max 6 visits per accident)
Wellness Benefit (annual screening)	\$100 per year

Critical Illness covered conditions: cancer (invasive), heart attack, stroke, major organ transplant, kidney failure (end-stage renal disease), and coronary artery bypass graft. Conditions diagnosed within the first 90 days of the policy effective date are not eligible. Recurrence or new diagnosis of the same condition requires a 12-month separation period from the prior claim.

Pre-Existing Conditions and Waiting Periods

Under the Affordable Care Act, all MeridianHealth ACA-compliant individual, family, and employer-sponsored plans cover pre-existing conditions from the first day of coverage with no waiting period and no premium surcharge based on health status. This applies to all conditions including but not limited to diabetes, hypertension, asthma, cancer history, heart disease, and mental health conditions.

Employer-sponsored group plans may have an enrollment waiting period of up to 90 calendar days for newly hired employees. Once coverage begins, there are no condition-specific exclusions or waiting periods.

The Supplemental Shield plan is not ACA-compliant and applies: (a) 90-day waiting period for illness-related claims; (b) 12-month waiting period for pre-existing conditions; (c) no waiting period for accident-related claims. Full terms are in the Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047, Section 5).

Coordination of Benefits

When a member is covered under more than one health plan, MeridianHealth follows the NAIC model coordination of benefits rules. The plan covering the member as an employee is primary; the plan covering the member as a dependent is secondary. For dependent children covered under both parents' plans, the birthday rule applies: the plan of the parent whose birthday falls earlier in the calendar year is primary.

Companion Documents

This guide should be read with: **Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047)** — definitions, eligibility, waiting periods; **Claim Exclusion Reference (MH-EXC-2026-047)** — excluded services; **Claim Process Guide (MH-CPG-2026-047)** — filing claims, documentation, appeals.

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